

MARK SCHEME for the October/November 2013 series

0500 FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/32

Paper 3 (Directed Writing and Composition),
maximum raw mark 50

This mark scheme is published as an aid to teachers and candidates, to indicate the requirements of the examination. It shows the basis on which Examiners were instructed to award marks. It does not indicate the details of the discussions that took place at an Examiners' meeting before marking began, which would have considered the acceptability of alternative answers.

Mark schemes should be read in conjunction with the question paper and the Principal Examiner Report for Teachers.

Cambridge will not enter into discussions about these mark schemes.

Cambridge is publishing the mark schemes for the October/November 2013 series for most IGCSE, GCE Advanced Level and Advanced Subsidiary Level components and some Ordinary Level components.

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Note: All Examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the passage.

Section 1: Directed Writing

Question 1

This question tests Writing Objectives W1–W5 (15 marks):

- articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined
- order and present facts, ideas and opinions
- understand and use a range of appropriate vocabulary
- use language and register appropriate to audience and context
- make accurate and effective use of paragraphs, grammatical structures, sentences, punctuation and spelling.

AND aspects of Reading Objectives R1–R3 (10 marks):

- understand and collate explicit meanings
- understand, explain and collate implicit meanings and attitudes
- select, analyse and evaluate what is relevant to specific purposes.

Read carefully the article on 'Why I'm teaching happiness'. Write a letter to the Headteacher expressing your views on teaching about happiness. You may agree or disagree with the Headteacher's arguments. In your letter you should: explore and evaluate the Headteacher's views; use your own ideas to support your comments on the Headteacher's views.

Base your letter on what you have read in the article but be careful to use your own words.

Begin your letter: 'Dear Headteacher ...'.

Write between 1½ and 2 sides, allowing for the size of your handwriting. Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 15 marks for the quality of your writing.

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Candidates might use the following ideas:

Responses may include a wide range of points of which the following are examples:

A1 – The main points of the Headteacher:

- A school's education is normally all about exams when it should be balanced and help produce well adjusted and happy individuals
- High achievers can be too driven; some are very unhappy and their lives flash by in study/books
- Forming healthy relationships is as important as top exam results
- School is the place to teach happiness/psychology as children form good habits
- These lessons help by setting realistic goals/dealing with negative emotions and self acceptance
- Excellent preparation for university and for producing better members of society

A2 – Own arguments to support Headteacher's views:

- Examples of the stress of exams: making them feel ill, lead unbalanced lives (all study no play), not eating healthily, feeling overwhelmed
- Knowledge of factual subjects does not help one to know or understand oneself or feel entirely self-confident
- Happiness lessons would help with the pressure of adolescence/relationships/exams
- Happiness lessons would help them deal with pressure from parents/expectations of others
- With these lessons university would seem less daunting/empower them in a career

A3 – Own arguments to show disagreement:

- School should be for academic subjects/study and learning
- The curriculum is overloaded; exams results will be compromised
- Results are paramount; school is about competition and doing the best
- Today's teenagers are more mature/they know how to communicate/already have balanced lives
- We can find out about university and other aspects of life after school via the Internet/gap years/part-time jobs/experience outside school
- We are not 'tortured' or 'unhappy' – we know what we want, we understand that there's a price to pay, i.e. studying hard, and we don't want our time wasted by some adult's newly discovered ideology

Accept other relevant ideas derived from the passage and relevant to the question.

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The question is marked out of 10 for Reading and 15 for Writing.

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading.

Band 1	9 – 10	Gives a thorough, perceptive, convincing evaluation. Reads effectively between the lines. Shows understanding by developing much of the reading material and assimilating it into a response to the task.
Band 2	7 – 8	Some evidence of evaluation , engaging with a few of the main points with success. Uses reading material to support the argument. Occasionally effective development of ideas in the material.
Band 3	5 – 6	Reproduces a number of points to make a satisfactory response. The response covers the material adequately, but may miss opportunities to develop it relevantly or at length.
Band 4	3 – 4	Selects points from the passage rather literally and/or uses the material thinly . Does not combine points into a connected response.
Band 5	1 – 2	Parts of the response are relevant, though the material may be repeated or used inappropriately.
Band 6	0	Response does not relate to question and/or too much unselective copying directly from the material to gain a mark in Band 5.

Use the following table to give a mark out of 15 for Writing.

Band 1 13–15	Consistent sense of audience; authoritative and appropriate style. Fluent, varied sentences; wide range of vocabulary. Strong sense of structure, paragraphing and sequence. Virtually no error.
Band 2 10–12	Sense of audience mostly secure; there is evidence of style and fluency; sentences and vocabulary are effective. Secure overall structure; mostly well-sequenced. Writing is mainly accurate.
Band 3 8–9	Occasional sense of audience; mostly written in correctly structured sentences; vocabulary may be plain but adequate for the task; mostly quite well structured. Errors minor.
Band 4 5–7	Inconsistent style; simple or faultily constructed sentences; vocabulary simple; basic structure. Frequent errors, including sentence separation.
Band 5 3–4	Inappropriate expression; the response is not always well sequenced. Serious errors in sentence structure/vocabulary/grammar/punctuation.
Band 6 1–2	Expression unclear; flawed sentence construction and order. Persistent serious errors interfere with the conveying of meaning.
Band 7 0	Problems of expression and accuracy are too serious to gain a mark in Band 6.

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Section 2: Composition

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Questions 2 (a), 2 (b), 3 (a), 3 (b), 4 (a) and 4 (b).

Give two marks. The first mark is out of 13 for Content and Structure: see Table A. The second mark is out of 12 for Style and Accuracy: see Table B.

Write about 2 sides, allowing for the size of your handwriting, on **one** of the following:

Argumentative/Discursive Writing

- 2 (a)** Should a government influence people's diets? What are your views?
- (b)** 'Combat sports, where the aim is to injure one's opponent, should be banned.' What are your views on this subject?

Descriptive Writing

- 3 (a)** You come across an abandoned building you never knew existed. Describe its exterior and surroundings before giving details of how you enter. Describe the atmosphere inside and everything your senses experience as you explore the building.
- (b)** Describe a place called 'Paradise on Earth'.

Narrative Writing

- 4 (a)** Write a story entitled, 'The Great Pretender'.
- (b)** Write about how an old film had been obtained secretly.

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COMPOSITION TASKS: TABLE A – CONTENT AND STRUCTURE

	ARGUMENTATIVE/ DISCURSIVE TASK	DESCRIPTIVE TASK	NARRATIVE TASK
Band 1 11–13	- Consistently well developed, logical stages in an overall, at times complex, argument. Each stage is linked to the preceding one, and sentences within paragraphs are soundly sequenced.	- There are many well-defined, well-developed ideas and images, describing complex atmospheres with a range of details. Overall structure is provided through devices such as the movements of the persona, the creation of a short time span, or the creation of atmosphere or tension. There is no confusion with writing a story. Repetition is avoided and the sequence of sentences makes the picture clear to the reader.	- The narrative is complex and sophisticated and may contain devices such as sub-texts, flashbacks and time lapses. Cogent details are provided where necessary or appropriate. - Different parts of the story are balanced and the climax carefully managed. Sentence sequences are sometimes arranged to produce effects such as the building up of tension or providing a sudden turn of events.
Band 2 9–10	- Each stage of the argument is defined and developed, although the explanation may not be consistent. - The stages follow in a generally cohesive progression. Paragraphs are mostly well sequenced, although some may finish less strongly than they begin.	- There is a good range of images with interesting details which contribute to a sense of atmosphere. - These are formed into an overall picture of some clarity, largely consistent and effective. There may be occasional repetition, and opportunities for development or the provision of detail may be missed. Sentences are often well sequenced.	- The writing develops some interesting features, but not consistently so. Expect the use of detail and some attention to character or setting. - Writing is orderly and the beginning and ending are satisfactorily managed. The reader is well aware of the climax even if it is not fully effective. Sequencing of sentences provides clarity and engages the reader in events or atmosphere.

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	ARGUMENTATIVE/ DISCURSIVE TASK	DESCRIPTIVE TASK	NARRATIVE TASK
Band 3 7–8	- There is a series of relevant points and a clear attempt is made to develop some of them. These points are straightforward and logical/ - coherent. - Repetition is avoided, but the order of the stages in the overall argument can be changed without adverse effect. The sequence of the sentences within paragraphs is satisfactory, but the linking of ideas may be insecure.	- There is a selection of relevant ideas, images, and details, which satisfactorily address the task. An attempt is made to create atmosphere. - The description provides a series of points rather than a sense of their being combined to make an overall picture, but some ideas are developed successfully, albeit straightforwardly. Some sentences are well sequenced.	- A straightforward but cohesive story with identification of features such as character and setting. - While opportunities for appropriate development of ideas are sometimes missed, overall structure is competent, and some features of a developed narrative are evident. Sentences are usually sequenced to narrate events clearly.
Band 4 5–6	- Mainly relevant points are made and they are developed partially with some brief effectiveness. - The overall argument shows signs of structure but may be sounder at the beginning than at the end, or may drift away from the topic. There may be some repetition. The sequence of sentences may be occasionally insecure.	- Some relevant ideas are provided and occasionally developed a little, perhaps as a narrative. There are some descriptive details, but the use of event may overshadow them. - There is some overall structure, but the writing may lack direction and intent. There may be interruptions in the sequence of sentences and/or some lack of clarity.	- Responds relevantly to the topic, but is only a series of chronological events with occasional references to character and setting. - Overall structure is sound, but there are examples where particular parts are too long or short. The climax is not effectively described or prepared. Sentence sequences narrate events and occasionally contain irrelevances.

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	ARGUMENTATIVE/ DISCURSIVE TASK	DESCRIPTIVE TASK	NARRATIVE TASK
Band 5 3–4	• A few relevant points are made and may be expanded into paragraphs, but development is very simple and not always logical. • There is weakness of sequencing overall and within paragraphs. Paragraphing is inconsistent. Repetition and an inability to sustain relevant argument are obvious.	• Content is relevant but lacking in scope or variety. Opportunities to provide development and detail are frequently missed. • The overall structure, though readily discernible, lacks form and dimension. Paragraphing is inconsistent. The reliance on identifying events, objects and/or people sometimes leads to a sequence of sentences without progression.	• A very simple narrative; it may consist of nonsensical or confusing events. • Unequal or inappropriate importance is given to parts of the story. Paragraphing is inconsistent. Dialogue may be used ineffectively. There is no real climax. Sentence sequences are used only to link simple series of events.
Band 6 1–2	• A few points are discernible but any attempt to develop them is very limited. • Overall argument only progresses here and there and the sequence of sentences is poor.	• Some relevant facts are identified, but the overall picture is unclear and lacks development. • There are examples of sequenced sentences, but there is also repetition and muddled ordering.	• Stories are incoherent and narrate events indiscriminately. Endings are absent or lack effect. • The shape of the narrative is unclear; some of the content has no relevance to the plot. Sequences of sentences are sometimes poor, leading to a lack of clarity.
Band 7 0	• Rarely relevant, little material, and presented in a disorderly structure. Not sufficient to be placed in Band 6.	• Rarely relevant, little material, and presented in a disorderly structure. Not sufficient to be placed in Band 6.	• Rarely relevant, little material, and presented in a disorderly structure. Not sufficient to be placed in Band 6.

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COMPOSITION TASKS: TABLE B: STYLE AND ACCURACY

Band 1 11–12	Writing is consistent, stylistically fluent, linguistically strong and accurate; has sense of audience. Look for: • appropriately used ambitious words • complex sentence structures where appropriate
Band 2 9–10	Writing is mostly fluent, sometimes linguistically effective and largely accurate; may have some sense of audience. Look for: • signs of a developing style • some ability to express shades of meaning
Band 3 7–8	Writing is clear, competent (if plain) in vocabulary and grammar; errors perhaps frequent, but minor. Look for: • mostly correct sentence separation • occasional precision and/or interest in choice of words
Band 4 5–6	Writing is clear and accurate in places, and uses limited vocabulary and grammar; errors occasionally serious. Look for: • simple sentences • errors of sentence separation
Band 5 3–4	Writing is simple in vocabulary and grammar; errors are distracting and sometimes serious, but overall meaning can be followed. Look for: • definite weaknesses in sentence structures • grammatical errors such as incorrect use of prepositions and tense
Band 6 1–2	Writing is weak in vocabulary and grammar; serious, persistent errors; meaning is blurred. Look for: • faulty and/or rambling sentences • language insufficient to carry intended meaning
Band 7 0	Writing is difficult to follow because of inadequate language proficiency and error.